

every subject—be it fashion, computers, mobile, electronic gadgets, health, women, sports, art and interior design. Similarly, there are a number of news channels and more are on their way to dazzle the small screen. The debatable question is, how long will they survive?

MAHESH KAPASI

via www.indiatoday.in

Our Government should not forget that agriculture and rural unemployment are major issues to be tackled on a war footing. We can actually qualify as a real economic power only if we successfully bring our people above the poverty line. It will also be heartening to see India overcome the terrorist menace and carry on with development.

R. MURALIKUMAR

via www.indiatoday.in

Friendly Foes

It is unfortunate that Barack Obama chose to toe the traditional US line of subtly containing India through its strategic ties with the nation's adversaries ("Stars Without Stripes", December 7). The Obama administration evidently ensured that India addressed its concerns like isolating Iran by coercing it to vote for the IAEA resolution. Apparently, by supporting India, the US does not want to upset the diplomatic equation it shares with Pakistan, its

major non-NATO ally and its most important trading partner, China—the two nations that are currently hostile towards India.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

The Aftermath

In his essay, Prabhu Chawla has summed up the 26/11 debacle quite accurately ("26/11: One Year After", November 30). However, I feel that it

the description of bullet holes in Hemant Karkare's jacket amply proves that their quality was sub-standard. It clearly shows that we are not prepared to avert such a crisis.

WG CDR (RETD) R.K. KAPOOR,
Noida

The fundamental flaw in our administration is corruption. It has eroded the state and eaten the vitals of the nation—26/11 oc-



BANDEEP SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com

Adventurous fantasies aside, it remains to be seen if the attitude towards sexuality shifts from absolute conservatism to complete progressiveness in the near future.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, Bangalore

is the people of Mumbai, Maharashtra, to be precise, who must also share the blame since they have gone ahead and elected the same leaders again. R.R. Patil has come back to be the home minister of the state. The chief minister can deny that there was no scam in the import of bulletproof jackets but

curred because of this cancer. The onus now is on us the citizens to wipe out corruption. Exemplary punishment should be given to the corrupt in politics and administration at both Central and state levels.

V. RAMANATHAN,
Rengasamudram,
Tamil Nadu

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

FEBRUARY 16-29, 1980

MGR: Double Role?

All the world might be a stage but a chief minister cannot act while being in office—in films that is. But, "acting is an inseparable part of my life," said Maruthur Gopala Ramachandran

Menon (MGR), the matinee idol-turned-chief minister of Tamil Nadu. Stating that he would return to acting in April and that his first film would be released by Diwali, MGR is aware that his return to filmhood could well be at the risk of his political career.

The verdict of a court case regarding this very issue—as to whether or not he can act while in office—is pending. MGR will launch his own film *Imayathin Uchiyil* (Atop the Himalayas) with himself in the lead, playing the standard hero—one who is a paragon of virtue and wisdom and one who rescues damsels in distress while being perched on tree-tops and cliff-tops. MGR's decision to return to films came in just as one of his ministers P. Soundarapandian was preparing to quit his cabinet and the party. There was also a fear of the assembly being dissolved.

by Chitra Subramaniam with
Arthur Pais in Madras

MGR WITH JAYALALITHAA



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